Weekly cetuximab + head and neck radiotherapy

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00207 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before the first visit

Confirm the exact regimen, treatment aim, baseline tests, transport, support medicines and actual urgent contact numbers. Bring any hearing concerns, swallowing problems and medicine list.

STEP 2

Time in the unit

The first cetuximab infusion runs over 120 minutes; later infusions usually run over 60 minutes. Premedication and observation add to visit time. Your team confirms the observation period; no early discharge is promised after two doses.

STEP 3

Two departments, one calendar

Radiation appointments are separate from medicine visits. Keep one calendar showing both departments and tests; tell the team promptly about a cancelled session.

STEP 4

Practical help

Tell the team about travel, cost, work, caring responsibilities, communication or reading needs. Ask whether a support person or interpreter can attend and how treatment changes will be explained.

STEP 5

Leaving the unit

Check the next visit and blood-test dates, support medicines and who to call if unwell. Have the team replace example phone numbers before using the wallet card.

Sources: NCCP 00207 v6: official regimen. Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.